

IB English A: Language & Literature SL

Intermediate → Advanced Development Worksheet

Student: _____ Date: _____

Purpose: This worksheet diagnoses and develops language accuracy, vocabulary, speaking, close reading, literary analysis, and IB-style analytical writing.

Part 1 — Grammar & Sentence Accuracy

A. Correct the sentences

1. The writer use repetition to show the character's fear.
2. The character don't understand what is happening around her.
3. The author is describing the setting in a very effective way which make the reader feel uncomfortable.
4. Although the character was frightened, but she continued walking.
5. The use of short sentences creates tension and it also makes the scene more dramatic.

B. Combine the sentences into one sophisticated sentence.

1. The character is isolated. She refuses to communicate with anyone.
2. The setting appears peaceful. There are several details that suggest something is wrong.
3. The writer uses repetition. The repetition emphasises the speaker's frustration.
4. The narrator describes the house as empty. This creates a feeling of loneliness.

Challenge: Use although, while, whereas, which, suggesting that, therefore, consequently, or despite.

Part 2 — Punctuation & Academic Writing

Add the necessary punctuation.

- A. The narrator seems confident at first however as the passage develops her language becomes increasingly uncertain
- B. The writer asks why should we remain silent when injustice surrounds us
- C. The character says I don't know what you want from me but I can't continue like this
- D. The description of the city is particularly significant because it reflects the characters emotional state

Part 3 — Vocabulary Upgrade

Replace each basic expression with a more precise and sophisticated alternative.

very important: _____

very scared: _____
shows: _____
makes the reader feel: _____
says: _____
bad situation: _____
happy: _____
sad: _____
big difference: _____
talks about: _____

Challenge: Rewrite: "The writer uses words that make the character seem very sad and scared."

Part 4 — From Description to Analysis

Read: "**The empty streets stretched endlessly before him.**"

A. What do you notice? Write two observations.

1. _____
2. _____

B. Identify one literary technique: _____

C. What effect does it create?

D. What might the empty streets symbolise?

E. Complete: The writer uses _____ to _____, suggesting that _____.

Part 5 — Tone

Choose from: **anxious • sarcastic • nostalgic • hopeful • hostile • melancholic • confident • uncertain**

1. "Of course, because everything has always worked perfectly for us." Tone: _____

2. "She looked at the old photograph and smiled, remembering the summer they had spent together." Tone: _____

3. "You expect me to simply stand here and accept this?" Tone: _____

4. "Perhaps we could try again tomorrow. Maybe things will be different." Tone: _____

5. "His hands trembled as he reached for the door." Tone: _____

Advanced: Choose one and explain how the language creates that tone.

Part 6 — Close Reading

Read:

“The room had been silent for several minutes. Maria stood beside the window, watching the rain slide slowly down the glass. Behind her, the clock continued its steady ticking. She wanted to speak, but the words remained somewhere inside her, impossible to release.”

1. What atmosphere is created?

2. Find one example of imagery.

3. What is the effect of “slowly”?

4. Why might the writer mention the clock?

5. What does “the words remained somewhere inside her” suggest about Maria?

6. How does the writer present Maria’s emotional state? Write a short analytical response.

Part 7 — Evidence → Analysis

Quotation: **“The clock continued its steady ticking.”**

Technique: _____

Evidence: _____

Effect: _____

Deeper meaning: _____

IB-level interpretation: _____

Part 8 — Language & Literature

Read: “We are constantly connected, yet many people have never felt more alone.”

A. What is the central idea?

B. Identify a contrast.

C. Why is the contrast effective?

D. What audience might this statement target?

E. What might the writer’s purpose be?

F. Write an advanced analytical response.

Part 9 — Speaking Challenge

Choose ONE and speak for 60–90 seconds.

A. Does social media bring people closer together or make people more isolated?

B. Is literature more effective when it reflects real-life problems?

C. Can a writer influence the reader without directly stating an opinion?

Try to: give a clear opinion, explain your reasoning, give an example, use linking expressions, avoid repetition, speak in complete sentences, and develop your answer.

Part 10 — From Intermediate to Advanced

Rewrite each sentence to make it more analytical and sophisticated.

1. The writer uses short sentences to show that the character is scared.

Advanced: _____

2. The author uses dark words and makes the setting seem bad.

Advanced: _____

3. The character is lonely because nobody talks to her.

Advanced: _____

4. The advertisement uses a picture to make people want to buy the product.

Advanced: _____

Part 11 — Mini IB Analytical Paragraph

Choose ONE quotation from the worksheet. Write 120–150 words analysing how the writer uses language or structure to communicate an idea.

Remember: Point → Evidence → Analysis → Effect → Deeper interpretation

Student Self-Assessment

Rate yourself from 1–5: Grammar accuracy ____ / Punctuation ____ / Vocabulary ____ / Speaking fluency ____ /
Understanding texts ____ / Identifying techniques ____ / Explaining effects ____ / Developing interpretations ____ /
Analytical writing ____

One thing I am already good at: _____

One thing I need to improve: _____

One thing I want to be able to do in advanced English: _____

Teacher Answer Key & Diagnostic Guide

Part 1 — Grammar

1. The writer **uses** repetition to show the character's fear.
2. The character **doesn't understand** what is happening around her.
3. The author describes the setting in a very effective way, **which makes** the reader feel uncomfortable.
4. **Although the character was frightened, she continued walking.**
5. The use of short sentences creates tension **and makes** the scene more dramatic.

Possible combined answers: The character is isolated **because** she refuses to communicate with anyone. **Although** the setting appears peaceful, several details suggest that something is wrong. The writer uses repetition **to emphasise** the speaker's frustration. The narrator's description of the empty house creates a sense of loneliness.

Part 2 — Punctuation

- A. The narrator seems confident at first; however, as the passage develops, her language becomes increasingly uncertain.
- B. The writer asks, "Why should we remain silent when injustice surrounds us?"
- C. The character says, "I don't know what you want from me, but I can't continue like this."
- D. The description of the city is particularly significant because it reflects the character's emotional state.

Part 3 — Vocabulary

Possible answers: significant/crucial; terrified/apprehensive; demonstrates/illustrates/conveys; evokes/creates/elicits; states/asserts/suggests/argues; difficult circumstances/adverse situation; delighted/content/optimistic; melancholic/distressed/sorrowful; significant contrast/substantial difference; explores/examines/addresses.

Model: The writer employs emotionally charged language to convey the character's profound sense of fear and melancholy.

Part 4 — Analysis

Possible observations: the streets are empty; the setting seems vast; the character appears alone. Technique: imagery (and, with justification, personification/symbolism). Effect: isolation and vulnerability. Symbolism: emotional isolation or uncertainty about the future. Model: The writer uses visual imagery to emphasise the emptiness of the setting, suggesting that the character feels isolated and uncertain.

Part 5 — Tone

1. Sarcastic
2. Nostalgic
3. Hostile/angry
4. Hopeful
5. Anxious.

Model explanation: The writer creates an anxious tone through the physical description of the character's trembling hands. The verb "trembled" reveals fear without explicitly stating it, allowing the reader to infer the character's emotional state.

Part 6 — Close Reading

1. Possible: melancholic, tense, lonely, contemplative, uneasy. 2. “watching the rain slide slowly down the glass.” 3. “Slowly” prolongs the movement and contributes to the impression of time passing heavily. 4. The clock draws attention to time and contrasts with Maria's silence. 5. It suggests Maria wants to communicate but is psychologically unable to express herself; the phrase functions metaphorically. 6. Model: The writer presents Maria as emotionally trapped through imagery and metaphor. The slow movement of the rain creates a subdued atmosphere, while “the words remained somewhere inside her” suggests that Maria cannot express her feelings. The contrast between her desire to speak and her inability to do so highlights her isolation.

Part 7 — Evidence → Analysis

Technique: auditory imagery/repetition. Evidence: “steady ticking.” Effect: draws attention to silence and the passage of time. Deeper meaning: may reflect Maria's tension and inability to communicate. IB interpretation: The repetitive sound of the clock contrasts with Maria's silence, reinforcing the emotional distance and tension.

Part 8 — Language & Literature

Central idea: the paradox of modern connectivity. Contrast: “constantly connected” vs. “more alone.” Effect: challenges the assumption that technological connection creates genuine relationships. Audience: social-media/technology users or the general public. Purpose: encourage reflection on digital communication. Model: The writer uses contrast to highlight the paradox of modern communication. The juxtaposition of “constantly connected” with “more alone” challenges the assumption that technological connection necessarily creates genuine relationships. The concise structure makes the contradiction memorable and encourages the audience to reflect on digital dependence.

Part 9 — Speaking

No single correct answer. Assess fluency, vocabulary range, development of ideas, evidence/examples, analytical depth, organisation, and grammatical accuracy. Advanced responses should move beyond simple opinions and qualify or develop claims.

Part 10 — Advanced rewrites

1. The writer employs a series of abrupt, short sentences to convey the character's heightened anxiety, creating urgency and psychological tension.
2. The writer employs dark and unsettling imagery to establish an ominous atmosphere, positioning the setting as a reflection of the character's apprehension.
3. The writer portrays the character's isolation through the absence of meaningful communication, suggesting that her loneliness is both physical and emotional.
4. The advertisement employs carefully constructed visual imagery to appeal to the audience's desires, associating the product with an attractive and aspirational lifestyle.

Part 11 — Model analytical paragraph

The writer uses visual imagery and personification to create a sense of isolation in the description of the setting. The phrase “empty streets” immediately establishes the absence of human interaction, while the description of the streets as stretching “endlessly” exaggerates their apparent size. This makes the character seem insignificant and vulnerable within his surroundings. Furthermore, the vastness of the setting may symbolise his

uncertainty about what lies ahead. Therefore, the writer uses the physical environment not merely to establish setting, but also to reflect the character's psychological state.

Diagnostic interpretation

Intermediate: identifies obvious techniques, understands basic meaning, writes simple sentences, and gives straightforward opinions.

Upper-intermediate: selects relevant evidence, explains basic effects, uses some complex sentences, develops arguments, and speaks with reasonable fluency.

Advanced / IB-ready: analyses writer's choices precisely; explains how and why choices create meaning; offers alternative interpretations; connects language to purpose, audience and context; uses precise academic vocabulary; constructs sophisticated sentences; integrates quotations naturally; moves from observation → analysis → interpretation → evaluation.